

BlackRock ESG Fixed Income Strategies



Fund Objective

The BlackRock ESG Fixed Income Strategies Fund seeks to achieve positive total returns over a rolling three year cycle in a manner consistent with the principles of environmental, social and governance “ESG” focused investing and seeking to reduce its carbon emissions profile by allocating to green bonds, lower carbon emitting issuers and issuers committed to decarbonisation. The Fund will seek to achieve this investment objective by taking long, synthetic long and synthetic short investment exposures. The Fund will seek to gain at least 70% of its investment exposure through fixed income transferable securities and fixed income related securities (including derivatives) issued by, or giving exposure to, governments, agencies and / or companies worldwide. The Fund will seek to achieve this investment objective by investing at least 70% of its total assets in fixed income transferable securities and fixed income related securities, currency forwards and, when determined appropriate, cash and near-cash instruments. The asset allocation of the Fund is intended to be flexible and the Fund will maintain the ability to switch exposure as market conditions and other factors dictate. The currency exposure of the Fund is flexibly managed. The Fund seeks to invest in Sustainable Investments, including, but not limited to, “green bonds” (as defined by its proprietary methodology which is guided by the International Capital Markets Association Green Bond Principles) and its total assets will be invested in accordance with the ESG Policy. For further information please refer to the underlying fund manager factsheet.

Fund Information	
Fund Management Company	Zurich International
Zurich Fund Code	USDTT
Underlying ISIN	-
Zurich Fund Size	\$141.22
Launch Date	03/07/2017
Unit Price	-
Currency	-
Sector	Global Fixed Interest
Zurich Fund Charge	0.82%
Annual Management Charge*	0.55%
Ongoing Charge Figure	0.82%
Advisor Fee	0.03%
Product Charge	0.50%
Investment Management Fee	1.00%
Underlying SFDR Product Type	Article 8
FE Risk Rating	2 - Medium Low
Morningstar Sustainability Rating	
Morningstar Low Carbon Designation	
Sustainability Corporate/Sovereign Score	-

* This figure includes the charges and expenses that are deducted from the fund and are reflected in the unit price. Other charges which reduce the number of units you hold may apply.

Zurich is not a fund manager. Instead, Zurich offers access to notional units that mirror the underlying Fund. The name of the underlying Fund is replicated by Zurich, with the addition of the word "Zurich". Zurich does not set the investment strategy nor is it responsible for the asset manager’s adherence to it. Please find the Underlying Factsheet link.

Cumulative performance (as at 31/05/2025)							
	1 Month	3 Months	6 Months	1 Year	3 Years	5 Years	10 Years
% Growth	0.91%	1.64%	2.99%	6.66%	18.37%	23.76%	
Sector	0.20%	3.68%	3.62%	6.82%	4.96%	-3.00%	1.95%
Discrete performance (as at 31/05/2025)							
	31/05/2020 to 31/05/2021	31/05/2021 to 31/05/2022	31/05/2022 to 31/05/2023	31/05/2023 to 31/05/2024	31/05/2024 to 31/05/2025		
% Growth	5.88%	-1.25%	2.87%	7.88%	6.66%		
Sector	7.44%	-13.98%	-4.90%	3.32%	6.82%		
Annualised performance (as at 31/05/2025)				Volatility (as at 31/05/2025)			
	3 Years	5 Years	10 Years		1 Year	3 Years	5 Years
% Growth	5.78%	4.36%	-	Volatility	0.36	1.09	0.94



■ BlackRock Sustainable Fixed Income Strategies IPP
■ Sector Average

Source: FEfundinfo as at 28/02/2025, bid to bid gross in USD. Sector returns are based on the FE sector category highlighted opposite. They are provided for comparison purposes only. Past performance is not a guide to future performance

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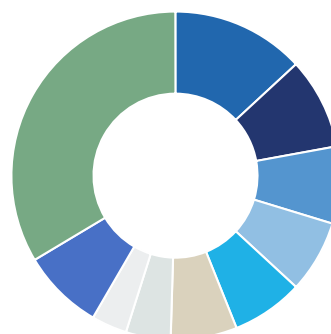
All funds carry certain risks, and it is important to consider these risks before making an investment decision. The value of investments and any income derived from them is not guaranteed; they can both fall and rise and may be eroded in real terms by the effects of inflation.

Key factors that may increase these risks include, but are not limited to:

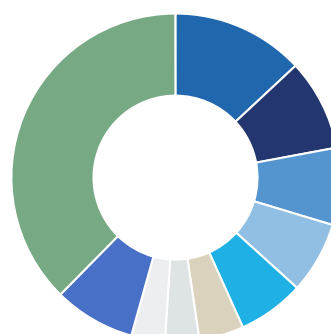
- The proportion of assets held overseas,
- Any concentration in specific geographic areas or industry sectors,
- The amount invested in property or property-related shares,
- The use of derivatives and other financial instruments intended to generate outperformance,
- Additional charges that may reduce the number of units you hold.

Asset Split (as at 30/04/2025)

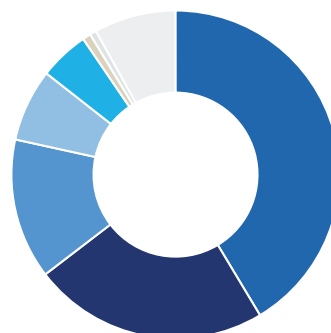
UK Fixed Interest	13.13%
US Fixed Interest	9.00%
French Fixed Interest	7.60%
European Fixed Interest	7.15%
German Fixed Interest	7.06%
Italian Fixed Interest	6.54%
Dutch Fixed Interest	4.42%
European Emerging Fixed Interest	3.50%
Money Market	8.04%
Other	33.57%


Geographic Split (as at 30/04/2025)

UK	13.07%
USA	9.00%
France	7.60%
Germany	7.06%
Italy	6.54%
Netherlands	4.42%
Australia	3.35%
Hungary	3.31%
Money Market	8.04%
Other	37.62%


Sector Split (as at 30/04/2025)

Corporates	41.39%
Government Related	23.20%
Securitized	13.86%
Government	7.14%
Covered	4.91%
Funds	0.81%
ETFs	0.65%
Cash and Derivatives	8.04%


Top 10 Holdings (as at 30/04/2025)

HUNGARY (GOVERNMENT)	3.31%
ROMANIA (REPUBLIC OF)	3.10%
MONTENEGRO (REPUBLIC OF)	2.46%
ITALY (REPUBLIC OF)	2.06%
MOROCCO (KINGDOM OF)	1.52%
ALBANIA (REPUBLIC OF)	1.31%
DEUTSCHE BANK AG	1.28%
NORTH MACEDONIA REPUBLIC OF (GOVERNMENT)	1.21%
FINLAND (REPUBLIC OF)	1.17%
FRANCE (REPUBLIC OF)	1.14%

Zurich sources its funds data from FEfundinfo. The date shown reflects the last available regional, sector and asset breakdown data provided by the fund's administrator to FEfundinfo. The timeliness of this data is affected by the speed and regularity of their publication by the fund administrator.

Additional Information

The fund invests in a range of global shares, with an emphasis on European markets. The regional bias was somewhat unhelpful over the quarter as European shares underperformed those in other regions, most notably the US. Political uncertainties in France and Germany and the release of subdued economic indicators eroded sentiment. We used the weakness as an opportunity to top up the fund's exposure to European shares and to benefit from any improved performance in 2025. These purchases were funded by selling some of the fund's shareholdings in Asia, Japan, and the US. The latter performed particularly well, following Donald Trump's victory in November's election and amid suggestions that his 'America first' policies could help support profitability among US-listed firms.

Commentary

Market Commentary as at 31 December 2024: Both Equities and Bonds detracted from performance over the quarter, as most of the major asset classes posted negative returns. Within Bonds, performance was broadly negative across the fixed income spectrum, with US Treasuries and Emerging Market bonds being the key detractors to performance. US Treasuries came under pressure as markets mulled over the potential implications of a second Trump presidency. For Emerging Market assets, dollar strength proved to be a significant headwind, particularly for local currency denominated bonds. Within Equities, allocations to the broad US market, Financials and US Small-Cap stocks contributed positively to performance, given that these were amongst the few parts of the market that managed to end in positive territory over the quarter. The broad US market benefitted from the continued participation of Large-Cap Growth stocks in the AI rally, whilst Financials and Small-Cap stocks firmed on the back of expectations that they would be key beneficiaries of a second Trump presidency. On the other hand, Emerging Market equities came under pressure, particularly Korean and Chinese equities.

Important

Important information

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